Summer 2026 Course Syllabus - Protest and Social Movements

Course	PSCI 4306.051
Course Title	Protest and Social Movements
Instructor	Kelvin Chun-Man Chan
Teaching Assistant	Aashutosh Shah
Term	Summer 2026
Meetings	Monday & Wednesday, 1:00pm-5:00pm, CB 1.218

Instructor's Contact Information

Office Location	GR 3.318
Email Address	kelvinchunman.chan@utdallas.edu
Office Hours	Monday & Wednesday, 12:00pm- 1:00pm (by appointment)
Other Information	For all UTD emails, please include "[PSCI 4306]" and your full name in the subject line in any email you send to me or to a Teaching Assistant.

Teaching Assistant's Contact Information

Office Location	GR 3.318
Email Address	aashutosh.shah@utdallas.edu
Office Hours	Friday, 9:00am- 11:00am (by appointment)

General Course Information

Pre-requisites, Co-requisites, & other restrictions	None required. All majors are welcome to take this course and no prior knowledge of course content is required.
Course Description	This course examines protests and activism to promote social change in a variety of countries around the world. Topics include the U.S. civil rights movement, the campaign to end Apartheid in South Africa, women's suffrage, pro-democracy movements, and right-wing, nationalist movements. Students will gain knowledge about the tools of activism and advocacy as they learn about several empirical cases.
Learning Outcomes	Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to: 1) Define what protest is and what social movements are, describe the types of protest activities and of social movements, as well as describe the connections and the differences between protest-social movements and voting-elections. 2) Explain the participation of individuals in protest and in social movements. 3) Explain the formation, development, and methods, including protest, of social movements. 4) Assess, among other topics, the effects on social well-being and public policy of, and regime reactions to, protest and social movements.

Required Texts & Materials	I do not set required texts for this course. However, each lecture would have required articles which students are expected to read before coming to class. All materials should be accessible from the UTD library.
Suggested Texts, Readings, & Materials	Chenoweth, E., & Stephan, M. J. (2011). *Why civil resistance works: The strategic logic of nonviolent conflict*. Columbia University Press. Chenoweth, E. (2021). *Civil resistance: What everyone needs to know®*. Oxford University Press. Della Porta, D., & Diani, M. (Eds.). (2015). *The Oxford handbook of social movements*. Oxford University Press. Sharp, G. (1973). The politics of nonviolent action, 3 vols. *Boston: Porter Sargent*. Tarrow, S. (2022). *Power in movement*. Cambridge University Press. Tilly, C. (1978). *From Mobilization to. Revolution, 1758-1834*.

Assignments & Academic Calendar

Week	Date	Topic
1	6/1	**Course Introduction – Why should we study protests? How could we compare different protests?** *Read before class* Chenoweth, E. (2021). *Civil resistance: What everyone needs to know*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 1. *Suggested readings:* Day, J., Pinckney, J., & Chenoweth, E. (2015). Collecting data on nonviolent action: Lessons learned and ways forward. *Journal of Peace Research*, *52*(1), 129-133. Raleigh, C., Linke, A., Hegre, H., & Karlsen, J. (2010). Introducing ACLED: An armed conflict location and event dataset. *Journal of Peace Research*, *47*(5), 651-660.
2	6/3	**Why people protests?** *Read before class* Aytac, S. E., & Stokes, S. (2020). Why Protest?. *The Wilson Quarterly*, *44*(1), https://www.wilsonquarterly.com/quarterly/the-power-of-protest/why-protest/ Della Porta, D., & Diani, M. (Eds.). (2015). *The Oxford handbook of social movements*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 13. *Suggested readings:* Tilly, C. (1978). From mobilization to revolution. New York: Random House. Chapter 1. **Protest case selection due (6/5) (Students are strongly encouraged to submit their topic choices before the deadline, as topics will be assigned on a first come, first served basis.)**
3	6/8	**Do we need leaders in protests?** *Read before class:* Della Porta, D., & Diani, M. (Eds.). (2015). *The Oxford handbook of social movements*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 18. McAdam, D. (1999). *Political process and the development of black insurgency, 1930-1970*. University of Chicago Press. Chapter 7.

		Pearlman, W. (2021). Mobilizing from scratch: Large-scale collective action without preexisting organization in the Syrian uprising. *Comparative Political Studies*, *54*(10), 1786-1817.
4	6/10	**Strategies for protests: Violent or non-violent tactics** *Read before class* Chenoweth, E. (2023). The role of violence in nonviolent resistance. *Annual Review of Political Science*, *26*(1), 55-77. Edwards, P., & Arnon, D. (2021). Violence on many sides: Framing effects on protest and support for repression. *British Journal of Political Science*, *51*(2), 488-506. Kadivar, M. A., & Ketchley, N. (2018). Sticks, stones, and Molotov cocktails: Unarmed collective violence and democratization. *Socius*, *4*, 2378023118773614. Sutton, J., Butcher, C. R., & Svensson, I. (2014). Explaining political jiu-jitsu: Institution-building and the outcomes of regime violence against unarmed protests. *Journal of Peace Research*, *51*(5), 559-573. **Response Paper #1 due (6/10)**
5	6/15	**The effects of radical flanks and dilemma actions** *Read before class:* Chan, S. K. L., & Wong, N. C. (2024). Blossom everywhere: the territoriality of Hong Kong's neighbourhood Lennon walls. *Space and Polity*, 1-19. McClennen, S., Popovic, S., & Wright, J. (2023). How to sharpen a nonviolent movement. *Journal of Democracy*, *34*(1), 110-125. Simpson, B., Willer, R., & Feinberg, M. (2022). Radical flanks of social movements can increase support for moderate factions. *PNAS nexus*, 1(3).
6	6/17	**Mid-term Exam (6/17)**
7	6/22	**Transnational dynamics** *Read before class:* Chow, W. M., & Levin, D. H. (2025). Muddying the waters: How perceived foreign interference affects public opinion on protest movements. *American Political Science Review*, *119*(1), 314-331. Keck, M. E., & Sikkink, K. (1999). Transnational advocacy networks in international and regional politics. *International Social Science Journal*, *51*(159), 89-101. Ritter, D. P. (2015). *The iron cage of liberalism: International politics and unarmed revolutions in the Middle East and North Africa*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 7;
8	6/24	**Outcome of protests: Democratic transition, consolidation, Repression** *Read before class:* Aytaç, S. E., Schiumerini, L., & Stokes, S. (2017). Protests and repression in new democracies. *Perspectives on Politics*, *15*(1), 62-82. Carey, S. C. (2006). The dynamic relationship between protest and repression. *Political Research Quarterly*, *59*(1), 1-11. Della Porta, D. (2016). *Where did the revolution go?: Contentious politics and the quality of democracy*. Cambridge University Press.. Chapter 1. Kalandadze, K., & Orenstein, M. A. (2009). Electoral protests and democratization beyond the color revolutions. *Comparative Political Studies*, *42*(11), 1403-1425. Lo, S. (2021). Hong Kong in 2020: National security law and truncated autonomy. *Asian Survey*, *61*(1), 34-42. *Suggested readings:* Bunce, V. (2003). Rethinking recent democratization: Lessons from the postcommunist experience. *World Politics*, *55*(2), 167-192. Yuen, S., & Cheng, E. W. (2017). Neither repression nor concession? A regime's attrition against mass protests. *Political Studies*, *65*(3), 611-630. **Response Paper #2 due (6/24)**

9	6/29	**Future of protest and social movements** *Read before class:* Hassan, M. (2024). Coordinated dis-coordination. *American Political Science Review*, *118*(1), 163-177. Holbig, H. (2020). Be water, my friend: Hong Kong's 2019 anti-extradition protests. *International Journal of Sociology*, *50*(4), 325-337. **Final review**
10	7/1	**Final exam (7/1)**

Grading Policy

1) Attendance: 10%
2) Participation: 10%
3) Response Paper: 20%
4) Case Presentation: 20%
5) Midterm Exam: 15%
6) Final Exam: 25%

Attendance:

You will receive 10 percentage points for attendance. As stated in the attendance policy below, you may miss up to two classes with no questions asked.

Students who miss more than two classes must obtain prior approval by email before missing a class session. Students who miss classes due to family or medical emergencies are required to submit a doctor's note or other relevant documentation by email on the day of the absence, either to me or to the TA.

For each additional absence without prior approval, 1% will be deducted from your final course grade.

Participation:

You will be awarded 10 percentage points for participation. Participation involves contributing to class discussions meaningfully and purposefully, asking relevant questions, and giving interesting comments. Thus, actively engaging with the class and your fellow students influences your grade.

Midterm Exam:

The midterm exam will be administered during class. Questions may include multiple-choice, True/False, and open-ended questions. Exam worth 15 percentage points.

Final Exam:

Just like for your midterm, the final exam will be administered during class. Questions may include multiple-choice, True/False, and open-ended questions Exam worth 25 percentage points.

Response Paper:

Each student is required to submit two response papers (no more than 500 words each) on eLearning throughout the semester. In these posts, students should explain what they have learned from the required readings and identify questions they would like to explore further during the semester.

You should aim to identify common themes or contradictions among the readings, establish connections with previous discussions, express agreement or disagreement with the arguments being presented, or apply concepts and ideas learned to current events

Case presentation:
Each student is required to give a 10–15 minute presentation on a protest case to the class. The presentation should explain why the protests occurred, identify the major stakeholders involved, discuss the tactics used by both the protestors and the authorities, outline the key demands of the protestors, and evaluate the outcomes of the protests.

As you may have noticed, this course is designed to address different research questions related to protests and social movements. This assignment is intended to help students develop a broader understanding of different protest cases.

Students may choose a maximalist protest case included in the NAVCO 2.1 dataset. If you would like to choose a protest case not included in the dataset, you must obtain my prior approval. To avoid multiple students working on the same case, students are expected to email me several topic suggestions. Topics will be assigned on a first come, first served basis.

Grading Scale:

A+ 97% - 100%	A 94% - 96%	A- 90% - 93%
B+ 87% - 89%	B 84% - 86%	B- 80% - 83%
C+ 77% - 79%	C 73% - 76%	C- 70% - 72%
D+ 67% - 69	D 63% - 66%	D- 60% - 62%

Course & Instructor Policies

Attendance, Punctuality & Participation
Consistent attendance and active participation are crucial for your success in this course and will factor into your final grade assessment. Attendance is defined as being present for the entirety of the class session.

Participation will be evaluated based on the frequency and quality of contributions to class discussions. Each student is permitted two absences from class without needing to provide an explanation or inform the instructor.

Make-Up Exams
These will only be considered for instances of an emergency (e.g., documented death of immediate relative or student hospitalization, etc.), you have an official UTD-sponsored event that conflicts with the exam date, and I am contacted via email before class on the day the exam (unless some documented event of force majeure prevents you to timely communicate the absence). UTD-related absences or religious holiday conflicts should be communicated to the instructor as soon as they are known, but preferably two weeks prior to exam day so we can make arrangements for the exam retake day and time. Documentation for all excused absences may be required.

Late Submissions
Assignments are expected to be submitted on the designated due date and in the specified format. Late submissions will incur a deduction of points from the assignment

grade (expressed as total percentage points: 10% within 1 hour, 20% within 12 hours, 40% within 24 hours, 100% more than 24 hours).

Email Use
UT Dallas recognizes the value and efficiency of communication between faculty/staff and students through electronic mail. At the same time, email raises some issues concerning security and the identity of each individual in an email exchange. All official student email correspondence will be sent only to a student's UT Dallas email address and UT Dallas will only consider email requests originating from an official UT Dallas student email account. This allows the University to maintain a high degree of confidence in the identity of each individual corresponding via email and the security of the transmitted information. UT Dallas furnishes each student with a free email account that is to be used in all communication with university personnel. The Office of Information Technology provides a method for students to have their UT Dallas mail forwarded to other email accounts.

Whenever you contact me by email, you can expect an answer within 2 business days of your submission. If something urgent comes up, please add the URGENT tag in the email's subject.

Academic Ethics
Every member of the UTD community is expected to maintain the highest standards of academic integrity. UTD may initiate disciplinary proceedings against a student accused of scholastic dishonesty.

Scholastic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, statements, acts, or omissions related to applications for enrollment or the award of a degree, and/or the submission as one's own work material that is not one's own. Scholastic dishonesty may involve, but is not limited to, one or more of the following acts: cheating, plagiarism, collusion, use of annotated texts or teacher's editions, use of information about exams posted on the Internet or electronic medium, and/or
falsifying academic records. While specific examples are listed below, this is not an exhaustive list and scholastic dishonesty may encompass other conduct, including any conduct through electronic or computerized means:

- Plagiarism is the use of an author's words or ideas as if they were ones' own without giving credit to the source, including, but not limited to: failure to acknowledge a direct quotation.
- Cheating is the willful giving or receiving of information in an unauthorized manner during an examination; collaborating with another student during an examination without authority; using, buying, selling, soliciting, stealing, or otherwise obtaining course assignments and/or examination questions in advance; copying computer or Internet files; using someone else's work for assignments as if it were one's own; or any other dishonest means of attempting to fulfill the requirements of a course.
- Collusion is intentionally or unintentionally aiding or attempting to aid another in an act of scholastic dishonesty, including but not limited to, failing to secure academic work; providing a paper or project to another student; providing an inappropriate level of assistance; communicating answers to a classmate about an examination or any other course assignment; removing tests or answer sheets from a test site; and allowing a classmate to copy answers.

Class Materials
The instructor may provide class materials that will be made available to all students registered for this class as they are intended to supplement the classroom experience. These materials may be downloaded during the course; however, these materials are for registered students' use only.
Classroom materials may not be reproduced or shared with those not in class or uploaded to other online environments except to implement an approved Office of Student Accessibility accommodation. Failure to comply with these University requirements is a violation of the Student Code of Conduct.

Generative AI
The use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, MS Copilot, etc.) to create content for assignments, quizzes, exams, analyses, or any other coursework is prohibited. This includes, but is not limited to, using AI to generate text, code, solutions, or any form of academic content that is submitted for evaluation.

All assignments and exam answers may be subject to AI detection checks. Even if you are not personally caught using AI during exams, you may still be considered in violation of the AI policy if there is reasonable evidence to suspect that your answers were AI generated.

While it is acceptable to use AI tools to help review and study class materials, it is your responsibility to ensure that all assignments and exam responses demonstrate your own understanding and knowledge.

Students are expected to complete all assignments independently and demonstrate their own understanding of the material. The use of generative AI in violation of this policy will be considered academic dishonesty and could result in disciplinary action.

Status	Examples
Encouraged	Checking something you wrote for spelling mistakes or to improve your writing style Answering technical analysis questions you don't know the answer to Suggesting potential sources for you to read as you prepare your assignments Cleaning up and structuring your notes from readings or lectures so that you can refer to them more easily later
Discouraged	Summarizing required readings you have not read Directly copying sources for you to include in your assignments, and only reading the LLM summary of what the sources say Coming up with arguments for you to include in your assignments Coming up with questions for you to ask in class
Prohibited	Conducting analysis for your assignments Giving you answers to reading quiz questions Writing sections of your assignments (or the whole assignment)

Re-grading
If you think your grade should be changed due to error, submit your work and a brief written explanation of your argument to me via email. Following re-evaluation, your grade may go up or down.

Any re-grading request must be submitted within 48 hours after the assignment or exam has been graded and posted on eLearning.

Comet Creed
"As a Comet, I pledge honesty, integrity, and service in all that I do."

Technology Requirements
Each student is required to have access to a device that will allow for them to engage with course materials, whether this be a phone, laptop, or tablet. Since the text is available in digital format and quizzes will be on eLearning, I encourage you to bring a laptop or tablet to class. The library has a stock of laptops that can be borrowed for students for education purposes. I understand how difficult it is to avoid using cellphones or scrolling online while in class. Out of respect to your peers/classmates and myself, I ask that you avoid this as much as possible, as well as silence your devices when entering class. If I observe that technology use is a distraction, I will point it out.

Free Speech and Intellectual Diversity
No individual is the same and all of you come from different backgrounds and hold different positions on a wide array of topics. It is okay to have different opinions and as your instructor, I encourage you to respect and be open to different perspectives, as well as feel comfortable with sharing your own personal point of view. UTD Policy Statement on Speech Expression and Assembly: https://policy.utdallas.edu/utdsp5001.

OSA Accommodations
Americans with Disabilities Act Statement: the University of Texas at Dallas will adhere to all applicable federal, state and local laws, regulations and guidelines with respect to providing reasonable accommodations as required to afford equal educational opportunity. It is the student's responsibility to contact the OSA office, located in AD 2.224 or call at 972.883.2098 to arrange for appropriate accommodations. If you are a student with OSA Accommodations that you will be using for the rest of the course, please reach out to me via e-mail as soon as possible so that I can make sure that I am meeting your needs.

Academic Integrity
Academic dishonesty of any kind (including, but not limited to, plagiarism, sharing, copying, or cheating on exams and assignments) will not be tolerated. In accordance with UTD's Office of Community Standards and Conduct, misconduct may result in a failing grade for the course, suspension, or in some cases, expulsion. For more information, see: http://www.utdallas.edu/conduct/integrity/.

Mental Health Services and Student Support Resources
I recognize the fact that students may experience anxiety and mental health challenges brought upon by life circumstances. As UTD students, you have mental health services available to you by telephone and on campus. Student Counseling Center

Phone: 972-883-2575; location: Student Services Building SSB 4.600. Moreover, UTD provides numerous resources for students in need:

The Center for Students in Recovery helps students seeking recovery from substance and alcohol use, eating disorders, and other addictions and compulsive behaviors. They also help students affected by these issues or individuals exploring the impact of addictions or compulsive behaviors within their lives. Their mission is to provide a safe, supportive community to enable students to thrive both socially and academically while living in recovery. They are located in SSB 4.500, on the fourth floor of the Student Services Building. They can be contacted by calling 972-883-7320 or they can be reached by emailing them at recovery@utdallas.edu.

The Comet Cupboard is a UT Dallas food pantry initiative dedicated to helping students in need. The Comet Cupboard is located in MC 1.604, on the first floor of the McDermott Library, and can be contacted by calling 972-883-6613 or emailing cupboard@utdallas.edu.

Comet Cents provides financial literacy to students with the peer-to-peer model. This money management center provides one-on-one appointments and workshops throughout the semester. Comet Cents works to help students improve their financial situation with topics such budgeting, credit card debit, investing and other personal finance areas.

Intercultural Programs provides a host of transition programs for international students and intercultural competency trainings for all students. They are located in SSB 3.6, on the third floor of the Student Services Building. Their phone number is 972-883-4528.

The Student Counseling Center offers confidential services to students either for individual appointments or as part of groups. Initial appointments must be made in person in the Student Counseling Center, which is located in SSB 4.600, on the fourth floor of the Student Services Building. Their main number is 972-883-2575 and the 24/7 Crisis Hotline is 972-883-8255 (972- UTD-TALK).

The Student Health Center (SHC) provides primary and preventative medical care to currently enrolled students who have paid medical fees and are attending classes. Currently enrolled students can obtain a wide variety of services, such as physicals, diagnosis and treatment of acute illnesses and injuries, general medical problems, gynecological problems, treatment of stabilized chronic illnesses, allergy injections, limited immunizations, x-rays, and ultrasound.
SHC staff of licensed medical providers is committed to keeping the UT Dallas community healthy and believes that health and wellness information complement the academic success of students.
SHC is located on the fourth floor of the Student Services Building, SSB 4.700 and they can be reached by telephone, 972-883-2747, fax, 877-769-7514, or by email, healtcen@utdallas.edu.

The Graduation Help Desk is a one-stop resource within the Office of Undergraduate Education designed to help undergraduate students overcome obstacles to a timely graduation. The Graduation Help Desk supports undergraduate students, faculty and staff to develop solutions to complex academic and non-academic issues. This resource is equipped to promote all undergraduate students' success by helping them at any point

during their academic careers from their arrival at UT Dallas until their graduation. Contact the Graduation Help Desk at graduationhelpdesk@utdallas.edu.

The Student Success Center (SSC) offers assistance to students in the areas of writing, mathematics, communication, multiple science fields, study skills, and other academic disciplines. These services are available through individual appointments, small group appointments, drop-in labs, workshops, and weekly reviews. All undergraduate students enrolled at UT Dallas are eligible to participate in these services. Not all courses will be supported by all services.
Please check the website at the beginning of each semester to find out which courses are supported by which services
In addition, students are expected to:

- know that this syllabus, including the course schedule, is subject to change at the discretion of the instructor;
- read additional related policy material at http://go.utdallas.edu/syllabus-policies.

The descriptions and timelines contained in this syllabus are subject to change at the discretion of the instructor.